

MADHYASTH DARSHAN · CO-EXISTENTIALISM

The Epistemology of Coexistence

Knowledge, resolution, and happiness — understanding evidenced in humane conduct

Based on the revised study (AnalyticMadhyasthDarshan.org)

Primary texts of Shri A. Nagraj — MVD · KD · SB · JV (tr. Rakesh Gupta) · 1 / 36





The Questions Epistemology Must Answer

- What is knowledge? — What makes understanding more than information or belief?
- Who is the knower? — What in the human being understands, chooses, and evaluates?
- What is known? — What reality, self, relationship, and conduct must be understood?
- How does knowing develop? — How does experience mature into understanding?
- How does error arise? — Why do belief, action, and result sometimes conflict?
- What counts as evidence? — How is understanding tested in life?

MOVEMENT ONE · §§1.2 → 1.1

What Knowledge Is, and Why It Is Needed

*Knowledge is realised understanding of coexistence,
jeevan, and humane conduct — and freedom without it
cannot reach the happiness sought.*

Answers · What is knowledge? · Who is the knower? · What is known?

Stakes first, then the claim · AnalyticMadhyasthDarshan.org · 3 / 36





Why Knowledge Matters

The human being belongs to the knowledge order, whose dharma is happiness, yet carries imagination and freedom of action without the understanding to direct them.

The aspiration — happiness

Happiness is the dharma of the knowledge order — not a preference but what the human being constitutionally seeks.

The gift — imagination and freedom

Human conduct is not constitutionally fixed as bodily orders are. People can hold incompatible beliefs and choose otherwise.

The failure — delusion

The body is taken to be the self, and sensory satisfaction is expected to fulfil jeevan. The aspiration remains; conduct cannot secure it.

The remedy — resolution

Samadhan is not calm. It is understanding the relevant realities together with adequate answers to the why and how of activity.



The Human Goal Sets the Stakes

Knowledge is needed for a definite goal. Madhyasth Darshan states it at four scales that must hold together, none substituting for another.

Resolution — in the person

Freedom from delusion and comprehensive resolution: the why and how of activity become clear.

Prosperity — in the family

Assured availability of physical means in excess of properly assessed need, not unlimited accumulation.

Fearlessness — in society

Rests on trust, justice, and freedom from exploitation, not on protection through domination.

Coexistence — in orderliness

Participation without contradiction in an undivided society and the wider natural order.



Knowledge, Wisdom, and Science Differ

Complete understanding must establish what is real, identify the humane goal, and determine practicable direction. The three terms are joined, but not interchangeable.



Gyan — knowledge

Realised understanding of coexistence, jeevan, and humane conduct: what is, who knows, and what right participation requires.



Vivek — wisdom

Knowledge by which the human goal — resolution, prosperity, fearlessness, and coexistence — is recognised and sensory or social motives are discriminated.



Vigyan — science

Directional knowledge for material prosperity together with the human and jeevan goals, including the law and process of activity and thought.



What Knowledge Must Include

Complete knowledge is threefold. Each content corrects a partial epistemology: reality without the knower is incomplete; self-knowledge without conduct is unproven; conduct without the whole lacks orientation.



Existence as coexistence

Omnipresence and all real units; their form, properties, essential nature, dharma, relationships, and participation in orderliness.



Jeevan

The sentient unit that bears attention, reflection, resolve, enlightenment, realisation, selection, evaluation, and authenticity.



Humane conduct

The right recognition and fulfilment of relationships, made evident as justice, work, behaviour, and participation in universal orderliness.



Knowledge Is Realised in Jeevan

Pervasive knowledge

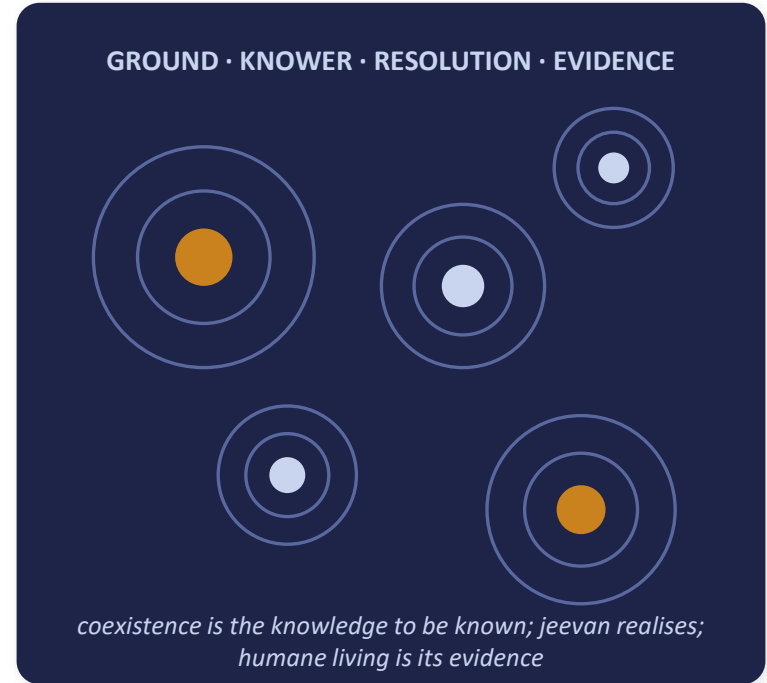
Coexistence of Omnipresence and Nature is itself the knowledge that needs to be known.

Realisation in jeevan

Jeevan is the knower. Atma realises coexistence; through buddhi, this becomes clear understanding.

Resolution and evidence

Realisation makes comprehensive resolution accessible—the why and how of activity become clear. Happiness is harmony within jeevan; justice and mutual satisfaction evidence understanding in relationships.





Knowledge, Knower, and Known



Knowledge

Realised understanding of coexistence, jeevan, and humane conduct — accepted, evaluated, and capable of guiding action.



Knower

Jeevan is the sentient bearer of knowing; the human being is the embodied participant through whom knowing is spoken, tested, and lived.



Known

Existence as coexistence: units, relationships, values, orderliness, and the conditions in which human aspiration can be fulfilled.



Meaningful evidence

The known becomes meaningful when understanding appears as resolution, prosperity, fearlessness, coexistence, and an awakened tradition.

Coherence without merger: jeevan knows, coexistence is known, and understanding does not dissolve what it knows — brahma satya hai, jagat satat hai.



Three Domains of Knowledge

The known is not exhausted by measurable form and property. Madhyasth Darshan distinguishes three connected domains, each with its own objects, capacities, and forms of evidence.



Physical knowledge

Form, property, material composition, production, and skill — knowledge expressed as effective engagement with material nature.



Intellectual knowledge

Meaning, relation, purpose, analysis, evaluation, and proficiency — thought disciplined by what is and what fulfils orderliness.



Coexistential knowledge

Realisation of coexistence, jeevan, and humane conduct — the horizon within which physical and intellectual knowledge find direction.



Cause–Doer–Effect Operates at Two Levels



Epistemic level

Karan is the knowledge-state, karta the human being, and karya wholeness or universal participation made evident in living.



Existential level

Coexistence is the ever-present cause, jeevan the doer, and human, deific, or divine status the effect according to awakening.



Sadhya — the aim

Awakening and established seer-status: freedom from delusion and capacity to understand, evaluate, and participate.



Sadhak · sadhan

The human being is the seeker; body together with jeevan is the means, supported by imagination, freedom of action, and tradition.

Action must be read with its level specified: ontological cause, epistemic state, human agency, means, result, and wider participation are related without being collapsed.



Seer, Doer, and Enjoyer

The awakened human is seer, doer, and enjoyer in one joint form. Seer-status establishes understanding; doing places it in action; enjoyer-status names the experienced fruit or fruition of action.



*goal: realised seeing
coexistence and relationship
known*



*goal: authentic conduct
work and behaviour aligned*



*receives fruition; in awakened
conduct this supports mutual
satisfaction*

One human joint form

*The seer does not withdraw
from action.*

The doer is guided by
understanding.

The enjoyer receives the result
and evaluates its fit with the
accepted aim.

Understanding establishes seer-status; embodied activity evidences the doer; experienced result evidences the enjoyer. Mutual satisfaction is one humane result, not the definition of enjoyer-status.

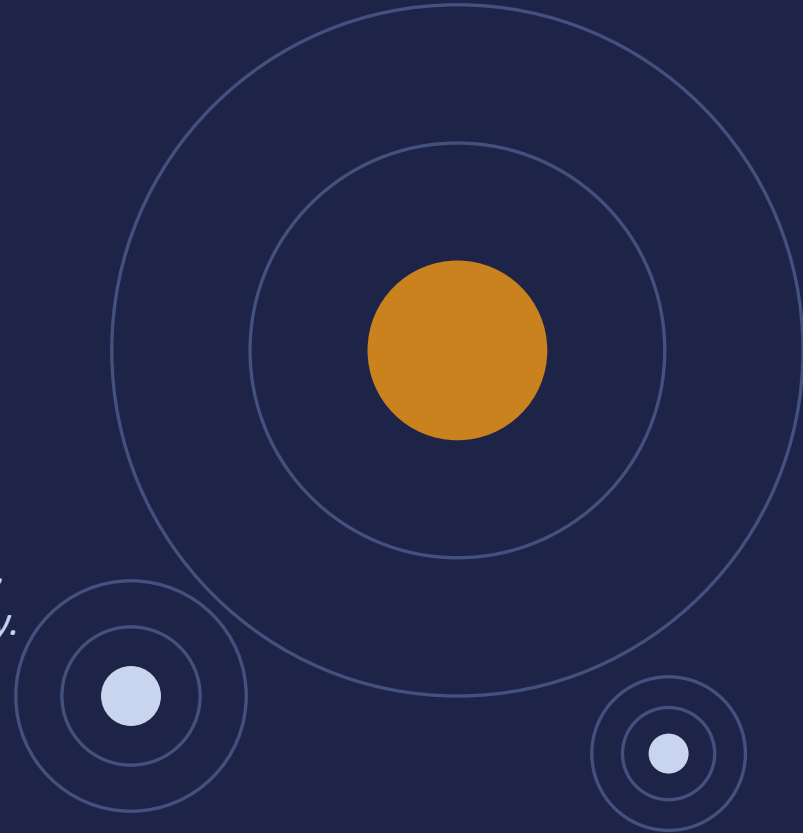
MOVEMENT TWO · §§1.3 → 1.4

Who Knows, and What It Governs

*Jeevan is the knower; its knowing must govern bodily life,
social motive, deliberation, and the order of every activity.*

Answers · How does knowing develop? · Opens · How does error arise?

The knower, then what it governs · AnalyticMadhyasthDarshan.org · 13 / 36





Five Loci, Ten Activities, Two Directions

The knower is jeevan: a constitutionally complete sentient unit whose ten activities sit in five loci. The same ten run in two directions.

Jeevan — five loci

- Atma — realisation and authenticity
- Buddhi — enlightenment and resolve
- Chitta — contemplation and visualisation
- Vritti — deliberation and analysis
- Mun — taste and selection



Two directions

- Inward — reflection: sensation and thought mature toward enlightenment and realisation.
- Outward — projection: realisation returns as analysis, selection, work, and behaviour.

Atma is madhyasth — mediative: its centrality attains the touch of knowledge in every dimension, evident only through integral behaviour and thought.



Knowing and Doing Form a Recurrent Cycle

This four-step diagram is a pedagogical synthesis of the textual account: attention and reflection deepen knowing; realisation and projection place it back into action and result.

Reflection — the knowing direction

Experience and consequence return through attention. Mun and vritti attend, chitta forms meaning, buddhi resolves, atma realises.

Projection — the evidencing direction

Realisation and resolve take form as visualisation, analysis, selection, bodily action, work, behaviour, and communication.

Each coherent cycle can deepen the next; reflection without projection remains unevidenced, while projection without reflection repeats habit.



Result and evaluation return the projected action to renewed attention.



The Human Being Seeks Happiness



Happiness

Harmony between mun and vritti: selection and deliberation no longer contradict the understood purpose.



Peace

Harmony between vritti and chitta: deliberation and meaning-bearing contemplation are mutually coherent.



Contentment

Harmony between chitta and buddhi: contemplation and enlightened resolve are mutually coherent.



Bliss

Harmony between buddhi and atma: resolve and realisation are mutually coherent in awakened jeevan.

These are relations among the activities of jeevan, not quantities on one scale. Material success cannot compensate for unresolved understanding, nor private calm for unjust relationship.



The Activities Are Legible in a Person

The ten activities divide again into force and power. Five are projected — named from what becomes observable in a living person. This is what links the faculty account to behaviour.

Activities of state — force

- Taste — mun
- Comparison — vritti
- Contemplation — chitta
- Enlightenment — buddhi
- Realisation — atma



Activities of motion — power

- Selection — mun
- Analysis — vritti
- Desire — chitta
- Resoluteness — buddhi
- Evidence — atma

Projected, these show as hope, thought, desire, resoluteness, and authenticity — a person's hopes and resolves are therefore epistemic evidence, not private states.



Jeevan Knows; the Body Mediates

Knowing belongs to jeevan, but human evidence requires the joint form. The body supplies sensory access, brain-mediated signalling, speech, movement, work, and participation with others.

Jeevan — sentient bearer

- Realisation, enlightenment, contemplation, deliberation, selection
- Evaluation of relationship and value
- Continuity of the knower across bodily change



Human joint form — lived evidence

- Brain and senses carry signals and bodily conditions
- Speech and action place understanding in a shared world
- Work, behaviour, and teaching make claims answerable to result

The texts specify a functional relation between jeevan and the brain; a more precise account of their interaction remains an open task within the exposition.



Cognisance Regulates Sensitivity



Cognisance — sangyansheelta

The knowing-and-accepting capacity through which jeevan understands relationship, value, purpose, and orderliness. It gives direction.



Sensitivity — sanvedansheelta

Embodied responsiveness through sound, touch, sight, taste, and smell. It supplies contact and capacity for action, never fulfilment.



Why contact is not enough

Sensory contact is required for bodily interaction, but repeating it never yields the continuous satisfaction jeevan seeks.



Balance, not suppression

The awakened human regulates sensitivity through cognisance while retaining both — recognising and fulfilling the world proceeds through that balance.

This is the distinction the next slide's fork turns on: which of the two governs bodily signals, material outcomes, and the selection that follows.



Delusion or Awakening

The decisive question is not whether jeevan is active, but what its activity takes as the self and what reference points organise attention, desire, thought, resolve, and action.

Delusion

Jeevan identifies with the body. Only four-and-a-half activities stay effective: taste, selection, analysis, visualisation, restricted deliberation — mun under lower-conformance.

Awakening

Jeevan knows itself and coexistence. The same faculties align around justice, dharma, and truth — mun under higher-conformance.

Higher-conformance is inspiration reaching mun from vritti, chitta, buddhi, and atma; lower-conformance is pressure from vitality, senses, body, and habit.



The aspiration for happiness remains, while conduct organised by sensation repeatedly fails to secure it. The named failure modes return at slide 31.



Four Propensities, Five Channels

The base field of humane conduct is bodily. Four propensities are engaged through five modes of contact: the four name which propensity is served, the five name how.

Four vishayas — the propensities

- Eating
- Sleeping
- Protection or defence
- Mating



Five sensory modalities — the channels

- Sound
- Touch
- Visible form
- Taste
- Smell

The propensities operate through these channels. The body retains rather than transcends these needs — the issue is governance, not suppression.



Social Motives Need Humane Direction

Resolution and the three eshanas form the next field, whose satisfaction is intellectual — longer than sensory, short of realisation. Samadhan orients the motives into fields of responsibility.



Progeny motive

Directed toward familial continuity, relationship, education in humaneness, and preparation of the next generation for responsible participation.



Wealth motive

Directed toward production, prosperity, right use, protection of resources, and material sufficiency rather than accumulation without limit.



Reputation motive

Directed toward accountable public participation and contribution to an undivided society rather than status or applause as an end.



Beneficence Must Increase Capability



Help and inspiration

MVD defines upakar as help and inspiration for another's prosperity and awakening.



Not a fourth eshana

It is neither an additional social motive nor an ordinary bodily activity, but a higher-human act.



Resolved capacity

It applies capacity already resolved in the giver to another's material sufficiency and understanding.



The test

Help must increase the other's capability and preserve mutuality between both participants.

Creating dependency or exploiting vulnerability defeats the stated ends of upakar.



Deliberation Weighs Six Perspectives

- ❓ Priya–apriya — Is it pleasant or unpleasant? A sensory reading, and relative.
- ❓ Hita–ahita — Does it nourish or harm? Bodily health, also relative.
- ❓ Labha–alabha — Is it gain or loss? Goods, services, exchange, material result.
- ❓ Nyaya–anyaya — Is it just? Behaviour within a recognised relationship.
- ❓ Dharma–adharma — Does it sustain resolution and orderly participation?
- ❓ Satya–asatya — Does understanding accord with realisation in existence?



Activity Carries Its Own Order



Niyam — law

The way an activity is protected and disciplined, so that it does not destroy what it depends on.



Niyantran — regulation

Regulation according to that law, not arbitrary external control. Choice stays with the accepted purpose.



Santulan — balance

The complementarity sustained when activity stays regulated in mutuality, fulfilling both parties.



Justice, dharma, truth

The awakened human's understanding and fulfilment of that order in behaviour, thought, and realisation.

MVD's sequence joins the two triads but does not equate them: niyam is not simply nyaya, niyantran not dharma, santulan not satya.

MOVEMENT THREE · §§1.5 → 1.6 → §7

How Understanding Becomes Evidence

Understanding is answerable to relationship, result, correction, and transmission — and the darshan's open problems mark where that stops.

Answers · How does error arise? · What counts as evidence?

Evidence, then its limits · AnalyticMadhyasthDarshan.org · 26 / 36





The Darshan's Own Evidence Regime

MVD p. 12 states the chain: realisation → evidence → understanding → manifest → resolution, work and behaviour → evidence → awakened tradition → coexistence. Its practical sequence is realisation, behaviour, experiment.

Realisation — the inward term

The knower directly understands coexistence, jeevan, and humane conduct. First-person — but not private immunity from examination.

Behaviour — the relational term

Recognition and fulfilment of values make understanding visible in family and social relationships, where mutual satisfaction can be assessed.

Experiment — the practical term

Work, production, and lived participation expose understanding to material conditions, consequence, and correction — not only controlled procedure.

Awakened tradition — the terminus

The chain closes where it began: evidence becomes awakened tradition, and awakened tradition is coexistence. Understanding must be independently liveable.



Knowing Must Continue Through Evaluation

Knowledge becomes effective through knowing and believing, then recognising actual relationships, fulfilling their values with capacity, and evaluating the result. Correct intention alone does not complete conduct.

Understanding

Know what is believed and believe what is known.
Acceptance without understanding is inherited belief;
understanding without acceptance remains ineffectual.

Justice

Recognition, fulfilment, evaluation, and mutual satisfaction
complete the sequence in relationship. Mutual satisfaction
is the outcome, not a fifth jeevan value.

Fulfilment depends on capacity, ability, receptivity, other people, and conditions; evaluation asks what was actually fulfilled and what must be corrected.





Every Karma Has a Structure

Activity together with aspiration is karma. Every intentional action contains a doer, cause, objective, result, and effect. Knowledge therefore becomes answerable to consequence: an intention is not sufficient, and a result cannot be judged without its aim, means, and reach.



*What is sought?
What would count as fulfilment?*



*What is chosen and done?
With what capacity and means?*



*What actually follows?
Does it satisfy the accepted aim?*

Five limbs of karma

Doer — who acts

Cause — the need

Objective — the aim

Result — the fruit

Effect — its wider reach



Consequence Returns as Evidence

Result is not the end of the process. It returns through evaluation: did the relationship, purpose, and value become fulfilled? The answer may confirm understanding or expose where conception, recognition, capacity, or action was incomplete.



*the fruit and effect
of action in context*



*compare result with
relationship and aim*



*corrected acceptance
shapes later projection*

Three evaluation errors

Over-evaluation
Under-evaluation
Mis-evaluation

Each can preserve
contradiction while appearing
certain.



Three Failures Block Knowing

Error is diagnosed by where the knowing process loses contact with reality, self, relationship, or result. Information and confidence can remain high while the deeper sequence is broken.

Delusion — bham

Jeevan is identified with the body; sensitivity becomes the governing reference, and believing separates from knowing.

Intellectual mystery — bauddhik rahasya

Reflection does not reach realisation, or realisation does not project as evidence; the faculties remain misaligned.

False learning is the middle failure: form, property, essential nature, or dharma is not understood as it is, producing doubt, over-evaluation, under-evaluation, and mis-evaluation.

Doubt



Mis-evaluation



Contradiction



Correction

Correction requires renewed attention, action, result, and evaluation — not a stronger assertion of the belief. Slide 20 named the condition; these are its failure modes.



Nearby Epistemic Terms Stay Distinct



Sensory contact

Indriya-sannikarsha is bodily contact through the five senses. It supplies conditions for cognition but is not itself complete knowledge.



Pratyaksha

Direct accessibility is not exhausted by sense-object contact; developed attention can bring form, property, essential nature, and dharma into proximity.



Sakshatkar · bodh

Sakshatkar is chitta's direct recognition or acceptance of meaning; bodh is enlightenment and resolve in buddhi.



Anubhav

Realisation in atma integrates understanding and bears authenticity. It must project as coherent explanation, behaviour, work, and evaluation.

Inference and testimony remain cognitive routes, but sensory contact, pratyaksha, sakshatkar, bodh, and anubhav name different relations and activities.



Understanding Must Be Conveyable

The primary texts do not present one canonical ladder with these exact labels. This pedagogical reconstruction shows a recurrent movement from language toward meaning, enlightenment, realisation, and evidence.

Study

Language and information provide an occasion for definition, comparison, reflection, practice, behaviour, work, and evaluation.

Guidance and tradition

An evidence-bearing teacher helps direct attention; the learner must move beyond repetition and become independently capable of understanding and evidence.

Comprehension is tested by the capacity to convey it. Conveyance requires more than fluency: the learner must explain, live, and evaluate without contradiction.

Language +
information



Knowing + believing



Sakshatkar + bodh



Anubhav + evidence

Transmission matters because knowledge claims to be universally accessible, not a private revelation that must remain ineffable.



What Conduct-Evidence Cannot Settle

- 1 Coherence is not substitution — admirable conduct does not verify a cosmology, and a successful production method does not verify the constitution of jeevan.
- 2 Some claims need domain-appropriate tests — physical process, neural causation, and post-death continuity are not settled by relationship or work.
- 3 The practical discriminations are still owed — restraint from repression, prosperity from accumulation, beneficence from dependency, stable harmony from temporary affect.

The framework is strongest when mixed cases and evidential boundaries are stated plainly rather than absorbed into a claim of awakening. · AnalyticMadhyasthDarshan.org · 34 / 36



The Questions, Answered

- ❓ What is knowledge? — Realised understanding of coexistence, jeevan, and humane conduct that becomes resolution and guides right participation.
- ❓ Who is the knower? — Jeevan, active through the human joint form as seer, doer, enjoyer, evaluator, and communicator.
- ❓ What is known? — Coexistence: units, orders, relationships, values, self, bodily conditions, and humane participation.
- ❓ How does knowing occur? — Through jeevan's coordinated activities, cognisance regulating sensitivity, disciplined study, and recurrent reflection–projection.
- ❓ How is error corrected? — Through renewed attention, action, result, evaluation, practical discrimination, and correction.
- ❓ What counts as evidence? — Coherence across realisation, relationship, mutual satisfaction, work, ecological practice, upakar, conveyance, and corrigible tradition.

Knowledge is complete when knower, known, conduct, and the human aspiration for happiness no longer contradict one another. · AnalyticMadhyasthDarshan.org · 35 / 36

THE CULMINATION · HUMAN GOALS AND JEEVAN VALUES

An Awakened Human Tradition

Knowledge is complete when realisation regulates embodied life and coheres across relationship, work, evaluation, upakar, and transmission.

Resolution

Happiness

Prosperity

Peace

Fearlessness

Contentment

Coexistence

Bliss

The relation is cumulative, not a mechanical one-to-one ladder; every scale must remain coherent with the others. · AnalyticMadhyasthDarshan.org · 36 /

